



F R I D A Y

SABBATH, A SPECIAL DAY

Saw

SCRIPTURE TEXT:

**“You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart,
with all your soul, and with all your strength.”**

Deuteronomy 6: 5 (NKJV)



LESSON OBJECTIVE

The Sabbath, marriage and the family go together in the Bible. Marriage (and the family) was the first institution established by God at creation, and the Sabbath was the second institution He inaugurated at the end of creation week, a memorial acknowledging God as Creator. The Sabbath is a very important day in the Bible and should be a special day in the lives of people who love and believe in Jesus.

On social media people tend to share their opinions about everything—sometimes based on “facts” they have read somewhere or grounded on something they made up on the spot. Very often social media posts are liked and shared by “friends” as if they were from God or someone connected to God. Much information shared about the Sabbath is often like a social media post based on someone’s opinion of what someone said, rather than a careful study of the word of God.

It is important for us to know today, the difference between information and values that come from God—the Creator of the universe—and those that come from anywhere else. Where an idea comes from will determine the worth or lack of importance it has. This means that the source of every idea is very important, since it determines whether we should take it seriously or simply disregard it.



God rested on the seventh day.

Read Genesis 2:1-3,
Exodus 20:8

The test for New York City cabbies (taxi drivers) has been reduced from more than 80 questions to only 10! Jesus did something similar with the Ten Commandments. Now that technology has given access to Global Positioning Systems (GPS), it has changed how well cabbies need to know the city to be given the privilege to drive a cab (taxi) in New York. Because smartphones are easy to obtain and they often have applications with a GPS, it is rather easy for cabbies to get where you want to go without knowing the city. Longtime yellow cab customers, however, are not sure they like this new system. One of them said recently: “If I got into a cab and the driver didn’t know where The Empire State Building was, that would be ridiculous. It would be like hiring a chef who has never cooked rice before.”

When a scribe came up to Jesus—in Mark 12:28—and asked Him which was the most important commandment of all, Jesus answered by quoting Deuteronomy 6:5: ***“You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul and with all your strength.”*** Jesus summarized the first four commandments by stating that obeying God in everything was the true purpose of the Commandments—that’s what loving God means. So, Jesus draws the distinction between head knowledge and heart knowledge.

A beginner New York City cabbie with a GPS may be able to map a course from JFK International Airport to a hotel in Times Square—but is the capacity of his GPS equal to the deep knowledge of the City of the seasoned veteran cabbie who really knows every block of the City and can see Times Square in his mind even before getting there?

Therefore, to know about the Sabbath is to know that God gave it to us at the end of a long week of work and school as a means of helping us to slowdown and reconnect with Him. In fact, the Sabbath is God’s gift to humans, so we may experience rest, renewal, restoration, and worship. The Sabbath was given as a sign between God and His people—a sign of their allegiance to Him as their Savior and Lord.

This is exactly what was happening with Elijah on Mount Carmel in 1 Kings 18:21, 30. Because the children of Israel had turned their backs on God and had quit keeping the Sabbath and worshipping God with their families on a regular basis, Elijah appeared to confront them about what they were doing. He challenged the children of Israel to make up their minds who they were going to worship—God or Baal—and he repaired the altar of the Lord—because it was broken down—so the children of Israel could get back to establishing the habit of worshipping the true God of heaven.

Today we encourage you to choose God by being obedient to the commandments—especially keeping the Sabbath—as God ordained from the very beginning of time. And rebuild your family altars—if they have been broken down—so you can regularly call on the name of the Lord with your family during your daily family worships.



PRAYER

Dear God, we want to do Your will by obeying Your commandments. Help us to experience the power of Your presence, so that we may experience Your power in our lives. Help us to choose You today and every day. Save us when You come to take Your children to heaven. In Jesus’ name, amen.

APPLY IT & LIVE IT



BIBLE CHALLENGE

Recite the memory
verse as a family.
Share it with a
friend or neighbor.



FAMILY TALK

- What makes the Sabbath a special day?
- Do we sometimes forget to "remember to keep the Sabbath holy?" (Exodus 20:8). What are ways that we can remember the Sabbath?
- Do you recognize that the Sabbath is a gift from your Father in Heaven who loves you and wants you to enjoy abundant life on earth and in the world to come?



REBUILDING THE FAMILY ALTAR

Decide as a family what you will do to make Sabbath special.

Set a time for sundown worship each Friday evening to welcome the Sabbath and plan to use the idea of a preparation day to do just that—prepare for the Sabbath—so you can concentrate on worshipping God and communing with Him as a family, rather than being busy doing things that do not connect you with God or enhance your relationship with Him.

Find ways to make Sabbath special and celebrate the joy you experience and share that with each other at sundown worship on Sabbath evening, thanking God for the day of rest and the opportunity to connect with each other, worship Him and take the time to share God with your neighbors and friends.

Families today are driven by fast-moving schedules. The Sabbath is our gift from God that provides a sweet oasis of rest. Developing routines that remind us about the approaching day of rest can help prepare our minds for this special time. We can train our brains to anticipate the Sabbath by cultivating habits such as tidying the house, getting our clothes ready for church, buying or baking bread, eating a special meal, or playing favorite hymns. Using a book of Bible stories that is only read at Friday evening worships, and engaging in other Sabbath-specific activities will help to make celebrating Sabbath a special occasion for our families.

